Unit 8 — School Around the World

Track E · Klasse 6 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can compare two school days using 5 comparative forms.*
- *I can name 8 differences between schools in 3 countries.*
- *I can write a 120-word comparison letter.*

Lead-in I

Lina has a pen-pal in Tokyo. Sam has a pen-pal in Cape Town. The three of them compare their school days by e-mail. Tokyo: 8:00 to 15:30, six lessons and a cleaning duty. Cape Town: 7:45 to 14:30, with a break that involves actual fruit. Stuttgart: 7:55 to 13:20, no fruit, no cleaning. ”We are very specialised,” Lina jokes.

Reading I

Reading — *Three school days*
In Tokyo, students clean their classroom every day after lessons. In Cape Town, the school year starts in January. In Stuttgart, students have free periods if a teacher is absent. In Tokyo, lunch is served at school. In Cape Town, many students bring fruit. In Stuttgart, lunch is at home or in the canteen.

Grammar — comparative + superlative
Short adjectives: *+ -er, the + -est*: *long → longer → the longest.* Long adjectives: *more + adj, the most + adj*: *interesting → more interesting → the most interesting.* Irregular: *good → better → the best, bad → worse → the worst.*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Build comparative + superlative: long → ___ / ___ ; interesting → ___ / ___ ; good → ___ / ___ .
2. Compare: Tokyo / Stuttgart / school day / longer → ___ .

Niveau E — productive

3. Build 4 comparison sentences about Stuttgart vs. Tokyo vs. Cape Town. Use one superlative.

Your turn I

Pen-pal comparison letter. Write 120 words to a pen-pal abroad. Use 5 comparatives and 1 superlative.

Sample

Hi Hiro, my school day is shorter than yours, but I think yours is more interesting because you clean your classroom together every day. We don't do that, but I think it would be a better tradition than the one we have. Out of all my lessons, biology is the best — the teacher tells stories instead of lecturing. We finish at 1:20 and I am always hungrier than my brother by lunchtime, although he claims this is physically impossible.

Reflect I

- I can build comparative + superlative forms.
- I can compare two school days in 4 sentences.
- I can write a 120-word pen-pal comparison letter.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Bitesize — *School around the world*.
- British Council Schools Online.